

Admin dashboard: UI/UX audit

Huchu schools vertical audit · Admin dashboard: UI/UX audit · admin/ui-ux.md · rendered 2026-09-14

Surface: the setup and master-data screens: `app/management/master-data/schools/{years,periods,classes,subjects,grading,identity}` with their `MasterDataShell`, `app/schools/{calendar,timetable,teachers,teachers/assignments,staff,imports,documents,transport,library,library/loans,boarding/hotels,notices,messages}`, and the components under `components/schools/{academics,classes,subjects,teachers,staff,timetable,imports,documents,transport,library,boarding,notices,messages}`. Audited from source and from `docs/screenshots/schools/{records-desktop,the-roll/03-classes,the-roll/04-teachers,teacher-hr-*,imports-*,visual-pass-*/01-timetable,visual-pass-*/01-teacher}`. Workflow companion: `workflows.md` in this folder.

Rules applied: the platform UX playbook, the design-system rules, the campus canvas law, screen contract and states doc, `.impeccable.md`, `SPEC.md`. Evidence with line numbers in `../reference/backoffice-ui-ux-evidence.md` §2.

1. Verdict in one paragraph

The setup screens work but are hard to reach and hard to scan. The six master-data pages sit behind two navigation rails and a description line, then repeat their counts in chips and tabs, stack their filters vertically with the create button floating between them, and add a third control row for the table's own search. The timetable, the one screen that should be a grid, never shows one: three header buttons with the primary greyed, filters over two rows, and an empty state that explains what a lesson is. Teachers and guardians lists clip their actions column off the right edge. Title Case and ALL CAPS labels appear on documents, notices, boarding and years. Native date inputs render in the browser's locale on every date field. The imports wizard has the best copy in the module and then grows down the page instead of advancing. The identity settings page is the one place that gates its controls by role and explains it; nothing else copied it.

Runtime check (14 September 2026)

Verified on the seeded St Marys tenant as the head (see `../reference/runtime-verification.md`).

Confirmed at runtime: the master-data pages are absent from the school sidebar; the classes, timetable and teachers screens render as described, with "Find the employee" on every teacher row. Not reproduced: the clipped Actions column on the teachers table.

2. Screen-by-screen

Route	Component	Contract violations	Friction	Role awareness	Phone	Severity
/management/master-data/schools/years	<code>schools-years-content.tsx</code> → <code>schools-calendar-content.tsx</code> , <code>school-days-content.tsx</code>	MasterDataShell title plus description; two CreateButtons per tab; "Holidays & Events" ampersand and Title Case	Terms one at a time; "Make current" with no confirm	RecordActions gated	renderer present	P1
/management/master-data/schools/classes	<code>schools-classes-content.tsx</code>	PageHeading plus description; chips and tabs both show Classes 6 / Streams 0; filters stacked, "New class" floating, then a third row of Search, Search, Columns, Export; Capacity renders "-" not "—"	Streams as a second tab rather than rows under their class	gated	present	P1
/management/master-data/schools/subjects	<code>schools-subjects-content.tsx</code>	Same shape; two primaries "Add the standard subjects" and "New subject"	Pass mark 50 with no %; Classes count not a link	gated	present	P1
/management/master-data/schools/periods	<code>school-day-content.tsx</code>	Same shape; ?view=rooms deep link (good)	N dialogs for N periods; no "generate periods"	gated	present	P2
/management/master-data/schools/grading	<code>grading-content.tsx</code>	Same shape; duplicates the windows table owned by /schools/results/publish	"Make default" with no confirm	gated	present	P2
/management/master-data/schools/identity	<code>identity-settings-content.tsx</code> , <code>school-custom-fields-panel.tsx</code>	Settings shell (good); "Read-only for your role" alert is the pattern the rest should copy; explanatory paragraph under every control	Save bar is not the design-system save bar; no dirty indicator	gated (the only one)	not checked	P2
/schools/calendar	<code>school-calendar-page-content.tsx</code> → <code>school-days-content.tsx</code>	PageChrome (good); two CreateButtons; native date inputs	Edit is delete and recreate	gated	present	P2
/schools/staff	<code>school-staff-content.tsx</code>	PageChrome, band, TableControls (compliant); HR codes mapped to school words (good)	"End employment" only in the row menu; no bulk	gated	no renderer, five-column table at 390px	P1

Route	Component	Contract violations	Friction	Role awareness	Phone	Severity
/schools/teachers	schools-teachers-content.tsx (1,027 lines)	PageHeading plus caption duplicating the band; "Add Subject" Title Case; Title Case tabs; three control rows; "Find the employee" repeated on all eight rows (confirmed at runtime); the clipped Actions column seen in the older screenshot set was not reproduced at 1440px	Three tabs, three deletes; subjects CRUD here and in master data	gated	renderer ×3 (good)	P1
/schools/teachers/assignments	teacher-assignments-content.tsx	PageChrome (good); "Take it off them" copy is right	Bulk allocate lives on the teachers page instead	gated	no renderer	P2
/schools/time table	schools-timetable-content.tsx (925 lines)	PageHeading plus a two-line description; three buttons in a section header with the primary greyed; filters across two rows with the search orphaned; empty-state prose defining a lesson	Placing a lesson is a sheet with six pickers; no click-a-cell, no drag; clashes are a chip	useSchoolAccess used	at 390px the warning banner is 190px, then five stacked selects; grid below the fold	P1
/schools/imports	schools-import-content.tsx	PageHeading plus description; step 3 re-renders step 2's mapping above the results; "Earlier imports" always under the wizard with a pager for one row	Column mapping and rejection copy are the best in the module; Undo exists here and nowhere else	useSchoolAccess used	"Check the columns" heading wraps to three lines beside a paragraph	P2
/schools/documents	school-documents-content.tsx (938 lines)	"School Documents", "Report Cards / Fee Invoices / Class Lists / Attendance Registers", "Select Student", "Student No", "Invoice No" all Title Case; raw enum status printed	Pupil → preview → print is three clicks; batch by class only for lists and registers; four of eight sources missing	not gated (fine)	no renderer; fixed-width preview	P1

Route	Component	Contract violations	Friction	Role awareness	Phone	Severity
/schools/transport	transport-content.tsx (1,389 lines)	PageChrome (good); four variant="primary" buttons; three band CreateButtons; six explanatory paragraphs	"Put a child on the bus" is two clicks and four selects; the morning register is a good pattern	gated	no renderer	P1
/schools/library, /library/loans	library-content.tsx, library-loans-content.tsx	PageChrome (good); both register the app-bar title "Library"; two primaries each	Lending is three pickers; no barcode or accession quick entry; "Fines if back today" chip is good	gated	no renderer	P1
/schools/boarding/hostels	boarding-hostels-content.tsx, hostel-rooms-panel.tsx	Title flips between "Hostels" and the hostel's name on one route; Rooms and Beds sub-tabs plus a Properties card plus a bed-board card: three tables on one view; two primaries	Beds per room dialog; no "add 24 beds numbered 1 to 24"	gated	one renderer hit	P1
/schools/notices	schools-notices-content.tsx	"School Notices" Title Case; side card "A notice cannot be recalled" (:576-579) rendered as UI; toLocaleString ×6	No schedule, draft or recall	gated	none	P0 (copy leak)
/schools/messages	office-inbox-content.tsx	PageHeading plus description; assign-dialog description is rationale	Reply in page; "End the conversation" confirm is good; no unread badge in nav	gated	none: an inbox with no phone shell	P1

3. Screenshot findings

- **Subjects list (records-desktop).** Four levels of navigation (school sidebar, Settings rail, Master Data rail, page tabs) before the table, a description line, chips, stacked filters, a floating primary and a third control row. Mono codes as links and Core/Elective badges are good.
- **Classes.** Two navigation rails plus the sidebar; "The year-group ladder and the streams inside each one." as a description; chips and tabs duplicated; "New class" floating at the right of the second filter; a third control row; "Capacity -"; pagination for six rows; a 740px table in a 1440px window.
- **Teachers and teacher-HR.** Identity cell with mono id and email (good). Heading, caption and bar title; "Add Subject" in Title Case; three control rows; "Find the employee" eight times. The runtime capture shows the primary in the bar and no clipped column, so the older screenshot predates a fix.
- **Timetable (desktop and phone).** "No periods yet" banner with a real next step (good). Two-line description; three section-header buttons with the primary greyed; filters split over two rows with the

search orphaned; nothing to click to place a lesson; on the phone, description, three buttons, a 190px banner with a wrapped button, then five stacked selects; no grid.

- **Imports (desktop and phone).** Column chips, "did you mean", and "could be 3 April or 4 March — write it as YYYY-MM-DD" are the best copy in the module. Step 3 shows step 2's form again; "Earlier imports" always under the wizard; a dry run's "Not imported" badge reads as failure. On the phone the card header wraps to three lines beside a five-line paragraph.
- **Teachers on a phone.** Cards read well ("TCH-001 · Mathematics · No HR record · HOD · Class teacher"), but heading, caption, full-width primary, chips, band buttons, clipped tabs, two selects, search, Search, Columns/Export precede the first card at ≈ 610 .

4. Rule violations that recur

Rule	Violation	Where
A page is named once	MasterDataShell or PageHeading plus the bar title	all six master-data pages, teachers, timetable, imports, documents, notices, messages
One primary in the bar	Two or more primaries; primary floating in the page	years, subjects, calendar, timetable, transport, library, loans, hostels
One control row, one search	Stacked filters, floating create, a third row	classes, subjects, periods, grading, teachers
Never the same fact twice	Chips duplicating tabs	classes, subjects, teachers
Row verbs in a menu	Clipped actions column; identical per-row button	teachers
Sentence case	Title Case and ALL CAPS	documents, notices, teachers, years, boarding
Dates as 3 June 2026	Native date inputs	calendar, timetable, imports, documents
Strip explanatory copy	Descriptions under every title; paragraphs under controls; prose empty states	most setup screens
One table per view	Three tables on the hostel page	hostels
Distinct app-bar titles	"Library" twice	library, loans
Table becomes cards below md	No renderer	staff, assignments, documents, transport, library, loans, notices, messages
Progressive disclosure	Wizard grows instead of advancing	imports

5. Suggested edits

P0

1. Remove the rationale card from notices (`schools-notices-content.tsx:576-582`).
2. Bring the Setup band into the school sidebar (see workflows B1) so these screens are reachable in one rail.

P1 3. Replace `MasterDataShell` descriptions and `PageHeadings` with `PageChrome` (pass `description={undefined}` in `app/management/master-data/schools/*/page.tsx` as the minimum); move the create verb into the bar; delete captions that repeat chips. 4. Wrap filters in `TableControls` with `actions=` and remove

the DataTable's internal search on classes, subjects, periods, grading and teachers, so each screen has one control row and one search. 5. Teachers: fold HR RECORD into a badge that is the link; move "Find the employee" into the row menu or a band action "Link 8 teachers to HR"; `layout="menu"` on the actions; hide PROFILE FLAGS by default. 6. Timetable: bar primary "Add lesson"; band actions "Build the week" and "Copy forward"; one control row; the grid is the surface with `+` targets in empty cells that open the lesson sheet pre-filled; clashes as red cells; hide "Build timetable" when there are no periods and let the banner carry the requirement. 7. Title Case sweep: `school-documents-content.tsx:687, 770-773, 782, 267-272, 406-411`; `schools-notices-content.tsx:369`; `boarding-allocations-content.tsx:258, 294-298, 338, 388`; `boarding-leave-content.tsx:214-215, 223`; `schools-teachers-content.tsx:660, 715`; `schools-years-content.tsx:78, 90`. 8. Native dates to the design-system picker (sheet on phone) across the 18 files. 9. Library loans: app-bar title "Library loans". 10. Hostels: list and record on separate routes; one table per tab. 11. Phone renderers for staff, assignments, documents, transport, library, loans, notices, messages. 12. Explanatory paragraphs: keep only those that carry a changing number, as a band chip.

P2 13. Imports: collapse completed steps to a one-line summary with "Change"; move "Earlier imports" behind a tab; label a dry run "Checked, nothing written". 14. Periods: "Generate periods" (start, length, count, breaks). 15. Beds: "Add N beds numbered from X". 16. Terms: "Add three terms" template when creating a year. 17. Identity settings: design-system save bar with a dirty indicator; copy its role alert pattern to every setup page.

6. Proposed restructuring

- **Setup as one band in the school shell** (`/schools/setup/*`): Years and terms, Calendar, Classes and streams, Subjects, School day and rooms, Grading and publish windows, Records and identity, Fee structures (link), Staff (link). One rail, `PageChrome` titles, no descriptions.
- **Master data ordered as imports need it**, with a readiness strip at the top of the band's landing page (see §7).
- **One home per entity**: subjects, publish windows and assignments each on one screen; the other pages link.
- **Teachers page split**: a Teachers list (profiles, HR link status, portal status) and an Allocation screen (bulk allocation, assignments); subjects go to Setup.
- **Accounts screen** under People: portal status per person, invite, resend, reset, disable.
- **Documents becomes a document centre** with all eight sources, batch by class, template per school, print queue.

7. Proposed new UI

Setup readiness (`/schools/setup`)

- Hero: Setup completeness, "7 of 10 steps", with the checklist in import order; done rows collapse; each row links to its screen.
- KPIs (two-up on phone): Teachers without an HR record; Teachers without a portal sign-in; Classes without a form teacher; Subjects with no teacher allocated.

- Queues: "Not yet set up" (rooms, periods, windows); "Data quality" (pupils not in a class, guardians without a phone, duplicate applications); "Imports" (last run, rejected rows, Undo).
- A school-year timeline strip: terms, holidays and publish windows on one line.

Timetable builder: the week grid as the working surface; class, teacher and room views; cell click to place, drag to move, clash highlighting; "Build the week" preview showing what will be placed and what cannot; exam mode later.

Account administration: a table of people with portal status (Invited, Claimed, Never signed in, Disabled), channel (email, phone), last sign-in; bulk invite by class with a delivery report; per-row resend and reset.

Interaction patterns to add: bulk actions (invite, link to HR, activate structures); ⌘K verbs ("New class", "Open the timetable for Form 3"); inline quick-edit for one-field changes (form teacher, capacity, pass mark); URL-synced filters; undo toasts for archive and delete; requirement banners as the only disabled state; route-level `loading.tsx`, `error.tsx`, `not-found.tsx`.

8. Accessibility

- Clipped actions on teachers are unreachable by keyboard; the menu fixes it.
- Native date inputs announce in the browser locale and render US order; the picker fixes format and announcement.
- Title Case and ALL CAPS group headers are read letter by letter by some screen readers.
- Icon-only buttons in the import stepper and the timetable grid need names; the greyed primary needs its requirement as visible text, not a `title`.
- The identity page's read-only alert is the right pattern: it tells the reader why controls are inert and who can change them.